

CS-UY 1114

Introduction to Programming and Problem Solving

Fall 2026 · NYU Tandon School of Engineering

Your Instructors

INSTRUCTOR

Salim Arfaoui

he / him

sa6468@nyu.edu

Sections: ALEC, BLEC

MW 9:30–10:50 AM · 6 MTC 315

MW 11:00 AM–12:20 PM · 6 MTC 475

INSTRUCTOR

Sebastián Romero Cruz

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370 Jay St, RM 843

Section: CLEC

MW 5:00–6:20 PM · 6 MTC 215

What This Course Is

An introduction to problem solving and computer programming using Python, built for CS and CE majors with limited prior experience.

Fundamentals

Variables, data types, operators, control flow

Functions & Files

Writing reusable code; reading and writing files

Data Structures

Lists, tuples, dictionaries, 2D structures

OOP & Recursion

Classes, objects, recursive thinking

Course Structure

LECTURE

Twice weekly

Monday + Wednesday
New concepts, live coding, discussion

LAB

Once weekly

Friday (or as scheduled)
Supervised, collaborative practice.
Mandatory.

OFFICE HOURS

CA + Instructor

Walk-in CA hours posted on
Brightspace
Instructor hours by booking link

NOTE

You must be registered for a lab section that corresponds to your lecture. Missing more than 3 labs forfeits all lab credit.

Grade Breakdown

65%

Exams

Midterm 1 (20%) · Midterm 2 (20%) · Final (25%)

10%

Rephactor

Quick Checks + Exercise Sets, due before/after each lecture

10%

Lab

Attendance + effort in supervised weekly sessions

10%

Lab Exams

Periodic in-lab assessments. Lowest score dropped.

5%

Attendance

Recorded at professor's discretion. Max 3 unexcused absences.

0%

Homework

Strongly encouraged and reviewed by CAs, but ungraded

Key Policies

NO PHONES

We know your attention span is already cooked (ours too, honestly). Phones away during lecture and lab anyway. Repeated use may get you marked absent, and phone use during assessments is an academic integrity violation.

AI TOOLS

Yes, we know these exist too. Using ChatGPT or similar tools on graded work (unless we say so) is academic misconduct. Using them to brainstorm before you write is fine. Submitting their output as yours is not.

ATTENDANCE

Life happens, which is why you get 3 unexcused absences for lecture and 3 for labs before you lose credit. More than 15 minutes late counts as absent. Anything beyond that goes through the Office of Student Advocacy.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Programming together is fun. Submitting the same code is not collaboration, it's misconduct. Keep your work yours, and don't post homework code on Ed Stem. We pursue all cases.

Textbook & Software

TEXTBOOK

Rephactor Python

\$48, purchased directly at rephactor.com
Register with your NYU email address
Your professor will send you a course code

Quick Checks due by 8 AM day-of
Exercise Sets due by 9 AM day-after

SOFTWARE

Python 3

Any Python editor works:
IDLE · PyCharm · Thonny

Some editors bundle the compiler;
check your editor's install instructions.

Schedule at a Glance

16 weeks, subject to small adjustments

Wk 1-2 Intro, variables, data types, operators

Wk 5-6 Loops, strings

Wk 9 EXAM 1 · File I/O

Wk 12-13 Dictionaries

Wk 14-15 Comprehensions, OOP (3 parts)

Wk 3-4 Booleans, libraries, selection statements

Wk 7-8 Functions, file basics

Wk 10-11 Exceptions, lists, tuples, memory maps

Wk 13 EXAM 2

Wk 15-16 Recursion, final review

Getting Help

INSTRUCTOR OFFICE HOURS

Book via the link in Brightspace. Come with specific questions; we're happy to help you work through things.

CA OFFICE HOURS

Walk-in hours posted on Brightspace. Start your assignment first so CAs can help you move forward, not start from scratch.

ED STEM

Discussion forum via Brightspace. No homework code in posts. Use your real name. Grade disputes belong in office hours.

DISABILITIES & ACCOMMODATIONS

Moses Center for Students with Disabilities: mosescsd@nyu.edu · 212-998-4980 · 726 Broadway, 3rd floor

Questions?